

Comparison: Array vs Linked List in C#

Feature	Array	Linked List
Memory Allocation	Contiguous block in memory	Nodes allocated separately (non-contiguous)
Access Time	Fast random access ($O(1)$ via index)	Sequential access ($O(n)$ to reach a node)
Insertion/Deletion	Expensive in middle ($O(n)$)	Efficient in middle ($O(1)$ if node known)
Size	Fixed size (unless using dynamic arrays like <code>List<T></code>)	Dynamic size (grows/shrinks easily)
Memory Usage	Less memory overhead	More memory (extra pointer per node)
Cache Performance	Better (due to locality)	Poorer (nodes scattered in memory)
Built-in Types	<code>Array</code> , <code>List<T></code>	<code>LinkedList<T></code>

When to Use:

- Array: When you need fast access by index and a fixed or predictable size.
- Linked List: When you need frequent insertions/deletions and don't care about direct indexing.